

Hollow Soul Master Design And Beta Roadmap

Date: 2026-05-19

Status: Canonical planning draft for review before runtime implementation

Source: */Users/martinjedrzejewski/Downloads/Hollow Soul _ Game Development.pdf*

Primary beta north star: Ship-Soul Loop

Scope policy: preserve the full vision, but keep beta ruthless

1. Purpose

This document absorbs the May 19 game-development PDF into one English canonical design package for Hollow Soul. It is not an implementation changelist. It is the decision layer that should be reviewed before new Unity runtime updates are committed.

The PDF contains a mix of game pillars, UI notes, currencies, item ideas, worlds, rooms, NPCs, special enemies, challenge rules, production tasks, story fragments, and pipeline notes. This master document sorts those ideas into design sectors, evaluates each named idea, and proposes the next beta roadmap from M126 to M135.

Related existing sources:

- *Docs/HollowSoul_GameDesignFoundation_GDD_V1.md*
- *Docs/HollowSoul_6_12_Month_Roadmap_Team_Capacity_Plan.md*
- *Docs/Milestone58BetaRewardEconomyChestBalance.md*
- *Docs/Milestone63BetaContentSelectionLock.md*
- *Docs/Milestone64VerticalSliceBetaLockGate.md*
- *Assets/_Hollow/Scripts/Hollow.Editor/Build/WholeGameAuditRunner.cs*

2. Executive Direction

Hollow Soul should be built around one readable beta promise:

Wake as The Prototype, survive broken portal worlds, collect souls, return to the ship, repair or unlock something meaningful, and choose the next risk.

The full game can support many strange worlds, NPCs, optional-risk chests, achievements, companions, alternate timelines, cursed variants, and secret endings. The beta slice should prove the loop, not exhaust the content.

Design priority order:

- 1 Combat satisfaction.
- 2 Soul economy meaning.
- 3 Ship/meta-progression clarity.
- 4 Readable rewards and chests.
- 5 World identity.
- 6 Optional-risk variety.
- 7 Full-system expansion.

3. Evaluation Rubric

Every source idea is evaluated using the same fields.

Field	Meaning
Current Status	How close the current Unity project/docs already are.
Beta Value	Low, Medium, High, or Critical value for the beta slice.
Full-Game Value	Low, Medium, High, or Signature value for the long-term game.
Cost	Low, Medium, High, or Very High production/implementation cost.
Risk	Main design, scope, readability, or production risk.
Recommendation	Beta Core, Beta Update, Post-Beta Backlog, Prototype Later, or Cut/Defer.
Target	Proposed milestone, backlog bucket, or deferred note.

Recommendation definitions:

Recommendation	Meaning
Beta Core	Required to make the beta slice coherent.
Beta Update	Existing or partial feature that should be polished for beta.
Post-Beta Backlog	Good full-game idea, not needed for beta.
Prototype Later	Interesting but risky; build only as a controlled experiment after beta fundamentals.
Cut/Defer	Placeholder, duplicate, off-tone, or too expensive for current direction.

4. Current Repo Alignment

Current systems already supporting the PDF vision:

- Room-to-room branch structure, hubs, boss clears, portals, and run persistence.
- Run souls, banked souls, coins, chests, shops, rewards, items, cards, weapons, armor, challenge records, and save snapshots.
- Sparse reward direction from M51/M58.
- Normal and golden chest foundations from M52.
- World framing and biome identity catalogues from M39/M50.
- Boss roster framework from M53.
- Challenge mode foundations from M35/M47.
- ArtPass wrapper, Developer Lab, visual safety, and Meshy integration paths.
- Advanced combat/AI foundations through M70-M115.
- Whole-game audit scaffold for M116-M125.

Current systems needing reframing for the PDF vision:

- Souls need stronger fiction, pickup timing, extraction, and ship-fuel meaning.
- Biomass is a strong concept but should not become a second fully deep economy before souls are clear.
- The ship should become the true meta-home; temporary hubs should remain between-reality choices.
- UI should show only useful player-facing information during normal play, hiding debug text.
- Room variety should expand selectively, not all at once.
- Cursed/demonic/portal chest ideas should enter as optional-risk prototypes, not random punishment.

Current systems to avoid expanding too fast:

- Large item/card volume.
- Full companion AI.
- Deep NPC quest chains.
- Many biomes and bosses.
- Complex alternate-world rules.

- Heavy permanent stat progression.
- Full vertical platforming before combat and rooms feel good.

5. Canonical Design Sectors

5.1 Core Fantasy

The player is The Prototype: a memory-damaged alien/bio-synthetic execution shell travelling through broken worlds. The Prototype is not a standard heroic knight, not a realistic space marine, and not a purely evil monster. It survives by fighting, consuming, extracting, and repairing systems it only half understands.

Canonical beta loop:

- 1 Start at or return to the Derelict Sanctuary.
- 2 Enter a portal run.
- 3 Clear rooms and survive a boss.
- 4 Collect souls, coins, items, and temporary resources.
- 5 Return or extract.
- 6 Spend souls to repair/unlock ship systems.
- 7 Open a new portal, challenge, archive, memory, or route.

5.2 Narrative And World Premise

The source PDF begins with a red cracked-land amnesia scene, crater, survival equipment, portal, tropical world, hidden technology, a system that recognizes the player, cockpit sleep, and documents revealing an old identity tied to a disturbing mission.

Canonical direction:

- Keep amnesia, portal discovery, hidden identity, ship recognition, and documents revealing partial truth.
- Replace the joke placeholder "Agent Tampon I / Federation XYZ" with the current canon of The Prototype, Derelict Sanctuary, and The Hollow Star.
- Preserve the reverse-character-arc idea: "Who am I?" becomes "Who was I?" and later "Do I want to be that?"
- Use false/incomplete memory as a mystery tool, not exposition overload.
- Use ship clues, repeating symbols, and recovered documents to foreshadow NPCs, companions, and boss/world revelations.

5.3 Player Controls

The source PDF proposes movement, aim, dodge, interact, melee, ranged, reusable item, card slot, pause, map enlarge, jump, and consume.

Canonical beta action set:

- Move.
- Aim/face.
- Melee attack.
- Ranged attack.
- Guard/parry where already supported.
- Interact.
- Use active item.
- Use card/consumable.
- Pause.
- Map enlarge.
- Consume, only if biomass/soul-consumption UX enters beta.
- Roll/dodge only if current M111/M112 work remains stable.
- Jump is deferred unless a very small vertical test is needed for enemies/projectiles, because platforming would reshape room design.

5.4 HUD And UI

The PDF calls for health, currencies, biomass, souls, minimap, active items, reusable items, keys, consumables, and card deck.

Canonical beta HUD should show:

- Health as hearts or a readable heart-like array.
- Run souls and banked soul context only where it matters.
- Coins or current run spend currency.
- Active item slot.
- Card/consumable slot.
- Key count only after keys become beta-active.

- Minimap with current room, seen rooms, rewards, boss/shop/secret hints where safe.
- Enlarged map view as a later or beta-polish interaction.
- Debug data hidden by default outside Developer Lab or explicit debug switches.

5.5 Combat

The PDF asks whether the game is shooter, swords, magic, or Isaac-like. Existing docs already answer: melee-forward 3D roguelite with ranged support, Isaac-like rooms, Dark Souls-inspired commitment, and Doom-like dark sci-fi tension.

Canonical combat priorities:

- Melee must feel good before adding many item effects.
- Ranged attacks complement melee.
- Souls-as-ammo is a strong optional risk, but cannot undermine the core soul economy.
- Shields should be readable equipment with durability or reliability only after guard/parry feel is stable.
- Light/medium/heavy attack tiers should map to timing, stamina, knockback, recovery, and shield pressure only if they remain understandable.
- Enemy attacks should keep active windows, readable windups, recovery, and no passive contact damage except explicit hazard cases.

5.6 Currencies

The PDF proposes biomass, souls, Black Orb, and resources.

Canonical economy roles:

- Coins: short-term run/shop currency.
- Souls: strategic resource for ship repair, unlocks, extraction choices, and long-term progression.
- Biomass: optional run-local consumption resource from bodies, best introduced after souls have meaning.
- Black Orb: completion currency for successful full runs, post-beta.
- Generic resources: cut/defer until a specific ship or crafting role exists.

5.7 Items, Cards, And Rewards

The PDF divides items into consumables, cards, single-use, multi-use, always-active, special items, falling stars, weapons, armor, and rarities.

Canonical reward structure:

- Ordinary rooms stay sparse.
- Treasure rooms, bosses, shops, special encounters, and risky chests are the item sources.
- Rarity is useful for the full game, but beta should use a small pool with clear value.
- Cards are consumable tactical events, not a huge deckbuilder system yet.
- Always-active items should be passive build modifiers.
- Active/reusable items should be few and readable.
- Special items should connect to NPCs, secrets, and unlocks.

5.8 Chests And Optional Risk

The PDF has a rich chest set: normal, golden, mimic, biomass, souls, demonic, corrupted, and portal chests.

Canonical beta subset:

- Normal chest.
- Golden chest.
- Mimic prototype only if visual readability is strong.
- One optional-risk chest type, preferably cursed/corrupted, with explicit player consent.
- Soul chest only after soul risk/extraction is clear.

Post-beta chest expansion:

- Biomass chest.
- Demonic chest.
- Portal chest.
- More mimic variants.

5.9 Rooms, Levels, Hubs, And Worlds

The PDF structures gameplay as rooms inside levels, levels inside worlds, hubs between choices, and a larger world progression.

Canonical beta structure:

- Ship base is the long-term home.
- Temporary hub or between-reality hub offers branch/level choices.
- Rooms remain the moment-to-moment gameplay unit.
- Levels/branches end in boss clear and return/extraction.
- Worlds are themed pools with weighted content.
- Dark/alternate worlds are long-term optional-risk variants.

5.10 Biomes

The PDF proposes many worlds: ancient Egypt, prehistoric, fallen future, end times, abyss, collapsed star interior, time loop, wreck field, hive planet, zero gravity, empty metropolis, machine city, radioactive sea, dungeons, tribute planets, loop world, heaven-hell, historical eras, and weather/temperature worlds.

Canonical beta biome rule:

- Choose 2-3 beta biomes only.
- Use the existing M50 catalog where possible.
- Each beta biome needs floor, walls, portal language, lighting/materials, enemy color/silhouette hints, and room dressing.
- Most worlds should become full-vision backlog until beta proves the core loop.

5.11 NPCs And Companions

The PDF proposes important NPCs, support NPCs, encounter NPCs, a Drunk NPC, Alien in meteor, Soul Eater, Dark Soul, fleeing creature, and companions.

Canonical beta rule:

- Add at most 1-2 special encounters before beta.
- Prefer encounters that prove reward/risk/ship-soul identity.
- Companions are signature full-game potential, but full companion AI should wait.
- NPCs should be memorable hooks, not a full quest network yet.

5.12 Enemies And Bosses

The PDF proposes Swallower, Mimic, Chameleon, Escapist, Dark Soul, Soul Eater, spiders, special bosses, demonic enemies, and world-specific threats.

Canonical beta rule:

- Polish a small roster instead of expanding count.
- Use current enemy AI foundations to make enemies readable and distinct.
- Mimic/Escapist/Soul Eater are the strongest beta candidates.
- Swallower and Chameleon are high-concept post-beta ideas.
- Bosses should focus on a beta subset, not the full roster.

5.13 Challenges And Achievements

The PDF proposes many challenge run rules and achievement unlocks.

Canonical beta rule:

- Keep challenge mode as curated fixed seeds/rules.
- Add only rules that use existing systems safely.
- Achievements can be designed now but implemented later unless they unlock beta-critical content.
- Challenge rewards should unlock items/world variants after the base loop is stable.

5.14 Art And Pipeline

The PDF lists tools, art asset tasks, spatial/model dimension guides, and a need for asset sharing.

Canonical production rule:

- The current project is Unity-based, even if earlier PDF notes mention RealityKit.
- Rafal's asset pipeline should remain Blender/Zbrush/Substance -> Unity ArtPass wrapper -> Developer Lab inspection.
- Generated AI assets can be concept/reference or controlled Meshy imports, never gameplay-authoritative logic.
- Every visual asset must pass scale, pivot, material, bounds, wrapper, and no-gameplay-script checks.

6. Idea Evaluation Catalogue

6.1 Core Fantasy And Narrative

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Amnesiac protagonist wakes in hostile red cracked land	Aligned with GDD V1 but not implemented as intro	Medium	High	Medium	Intro production can distract from playable loop	Post-Beta Backlog	Story intro backlog
Crater implies fall from height	Missing	Low	Medium	Low	Mostly cinematic/environmental	Post-Beta Backlog	Intro scene backlog
Finds survival equipment before first portal	Partially overlaps weapon/start loadout	Medium	High	Medium	Needs tutorial/onboarding design	Prototype Later	Onboarding prototype
First mysterious portal feels familiar	Existing portal systems; story layer missing	High	High	Medium	Needs visual/narrative clarity	Beta Update	M129
Portal leads to tropical green world	Existing world framing can support but not beta-selected	Low	Medium	High	Adds biome scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Biome backlog
Hidden technological structure recognizes the player	Ship recognition aligns strongly	High	Signature	Medium	Needs ship scene	Beta Core	M129
Cockpit/safe rest area	Aligned with Derelict Sanctuary	High	High	Medium	Can become too menu-like	Beta Core	M129
Documents reveal old identity and mission	Aligned with memory fragments	Medium	Signature	Low	Over-explaining too early	Beta Update	M126/M129
Placeholder identity "Agent Tampon I / Federation XYZ"	Conflicts with current tone	Low	Low	Low	Joke name breaks canon	Cut/Defer	Replace with The Prototype canon
Reverse character arc	Documented as compatible	Medium	Signature	Low	Needs restraint	Post-Beta Backlog	Narrative bible
False or manipulated memory	Compatible with Hollow Star mystery	Medium	High	Medium	Can confuse beta	Post-Beta Backlog	Narrative bible
Ship clues foreshadow team/NPCs	Missing but aligned	Medium	High	Low	Too many dangling hooks	Beta Update	M129
Repeating symbols revealed over time	Missing	Low	High	Medium	Art/narrative overhead	Post-Beta Backlog	World identity backlog
Black hole/Hollow Star as central conflict	Existing GDD direction	Critical	Signature	Low	Needs consistent naming	Beta Core	M126
Machine/laser/ship system powered by essence	Aligned with ship-soul loop	Critical	Signature	Medium	Can become abstract if not visual	Beta Core	M129
Save all worlds vs save one central world	Not decided	Low	High	High	Branching story scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Narrative choice backlog
Black hole reacts/fights back	Not implemented	Medium	High	High	Scope creep if systemic	Prototype Later	Post-beta anomaly systems

6.2 HUD, UI, And Controls

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Main HUD array with health and currencies	Partial/in progress through HUD systems	Critical	High	Medium	Can become cluttered	Beta Core	M127
Hearts or healthbar	Existing health systems; visual pass in progress	Critical	High	Medium	Must scale for max HP changes	Beta Core	M127
HP near/top of board	Partial/in progress	High	High	Low	Platform-specific readability	Beta Update	M127
Biomass display	Biomass missing as economy	Medium	High	Medium	Premature second economy	Prototype Later	M128 after soul clarity
Souls display for current run	Existing run souls	Critical	High	Low	Must separate run vs banked	Beta Core	M128

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Minimap	Existing and being polished	Critical	High	Medium	Must avoid debug text	Beta Core	M127
Enlarge/lift minimap	Missing or partial	Medium	High	Medium	Input/platform ambiguity	Beta Update	M127 or post-beta polish
Active item/reusable preview	Existing active item/card model partial	High	High	Medium	HUD clutter	Beta Core	M127
Bombs as reusable/consumable	Missing specific item	Low	High	Medium	Needs destructible/secret rules	Post-Beta Backlog	Chest/secret backlog
Potions	Not canonical yet	Low	Medium	Low	Generic reward noise	Post-Beta Backlog	Item backlog
Keys	Partial through boss/locks; not broad key economy	Medium	High	Medium	Can overcomplicate rooms	Prototype Later	M130/M131
One-use upgrades	Partial via rewards/cards	Medium	High	Medium	Needs clear category	Beta Update	M130
Card deck near player/right side	Cards exist; hand UI missing	Medium	High	High	Grabbing/throwing implies new interaction model	Prototype Later	Post-beta card UX
Movement	Existing	Critical	Critical	Low	Must remain reliable	Beta Core	M134
Aiming	Existing, M111 work	Critical	Critical	Medium	Mouse/gamepad/visionOS differences	Beta Core	M134
Dodge/roll	Partial, M112 tests exist	High	High	Medium	Invulnerability readability	Beta Update	M134
Interact	Existing	Critical	High	Low	Prompt clarity	Beta Core	M134
Melee attack	Existing	Critical	Critical	Medium	Must feel primary	Beta Core	M134
Long-distance attack	Existing	High	High	Medium	Must not replace melee	Beta Update	M134
Reusable item slot on L1	Existing concept/input partial	High	High	Medium	Controller mapping conflicts	Beta Update	M127/M134
Card slot on L2	Existing concept/input partial	High	High	Medium	Controller mapping conflicts	Beta Update	M127/M134
Pause menu	Existing	High	High	Low	None significant	Beta Update	M135
Map enlarge on touchpad press	Missing	Medium	Medium	Medium	Platform input variance	Prototype Later	Post-beta UI polish
Jump	Not core	Low	Medium	High	Requires vertical room design	Cut/Defer for beta	Post-beta movement prototype
Consume action	Missing/partial fiction	High if biomass enters	High	Medium	Needs corpses, timing, UI	Prototype Later	M128 only if scoped

6.3 Combat, Weapons, Shields, And Feel

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Ranged weapon consumes souls instead of ammo	Souls exist; ammo concept not soul-bound	Medium	High	Medium	Undermines soul economy if always-on	Prototype Later	M128/M134 experiment
Breakable/fixable shields	Guard/shield systems exist	Medium	High	High	Durability adds repair economy	Post-Beta Backlog	Equipment backlog
Light/medium/heavy attack types	Existing light/heavy; medium not central	Medium	High	Medium	Complexity before feel	Beta Update for light/heavy only	M134
Attack tiers with knockback	Knockback systems exist	High	High	Medium	Tuning readability	Beta Update	M134
Attack tiers with shield reliability	Shield behavior exists	Medium	High	Medium	Hard to communicate	Prototype Later	Post-beta shield pass
Two weapon types: melee and shooting	Existing	Critical	Critical	Low	Needs visual clarity	Beta Core	M134
Less pure magic/fire, more guns/organic/projectiles	Partially aligned	Medium	High	Medium	Avoid losing cosmic fantasy	Beta Update	M132/M134

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Magic as possible combat flavor	Existing enemy magic/soul enemies	Low	Medium	Medium	Too broad for beta	Post-Beta Backlog	Enemy/action backlog
Dark Souls challenge and soul tone	Existing combat direction	Critical	Signature	Medium	Avoid slow/clunky combat	Beta Core	M134
Isaac-like room pressure	Existing branch/room design	Critical	Signature	Medium	Avoid copying instead of owning	Beta Core	M131
Doom 3 dark sci-fi tension	Art/narrative direction	Medium	High	Medium	Too dark can hurt readability	Beta Update	M132
Vertical play area with stairs/ladders/platforms	Mostly missing	Low	High	Very High	Changes navigation, camera, rooms	Cut/Defer for beta	Post-beta movement/room prototype
Vertical projectiles	Partially feasible with current projectiles	Medium	Medium	Medium	Needs line-of-effect clarity	Prototype Later	Combat lab

6.4 Currencies And Economy

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Coins/run money	Existing	High	High	Low	Needs pacing	Beta Core	M130
Biomass from bosses and corpses	Missing	Medium	Signature	High	Competes with souls and needs corpse lifetime	Prototype Later	M128
Biomass usable in hub shop during run	Missing	Medium	High	High	Requires hub economy split	Prototype Later	M128/M129
Corpses consumable for 5 seconds	Missing	Medium	Signature	High	Corpses, timer, animation, UI	Prototype Later	M128
Souls for permanent unlocks	Existing partial banked souls	Critical	Signature	Medium	Must avoid stat grind	Beta Core	M128/M129
Souls unlock worlds, bosses, items, skills, characters, modes, collectibles	Partial concept	Medium	Signature	High	Massive unlock matrix	Post-Beta Backlog	Meta backlog
Souls unlock 3D model viewer	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Non-core beta feature	Post-Beta Backlog	Archive module backlog
Extract souls in hub and end run/death choice	Missing but aligned	High	Signature	Medium	Needs clear consequence	Beta Update	M128/M129
Risk continuing run with souls	Partial through run persistence	Critical	Signature	Medium	Must be fair	Beta Core	M128
Black Orb per successful run	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Adds another currency too early	Post-Beta Backlog	Completion economy
Generic resources from monsters	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Vague, likely clutter	Cut/Defer	Revisit only with crafting need
Souls sent to heaven/unlocked content	Narrative-compatible	Medium	High	Medium	Tone may become too moralized	Prototype Later	Narrative/economy backlog

6.5 Rarity, Items, Cards, And Rewards

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Common rarity	Partial reward definitions	Medium	High	Medium	Needs consistent tuning	Beta Update	M130
Uncommon rarity	Partial	Medium	High	Medium	Needs content volume	Beta Update	M130
Rare rarity	Partial	Medium	High	Medium	Needs content volume	Beta Update	M130
Epic rarity	Partial	Low	Medium	Medium	Too little beta content	Post-Beta Backlog	Item expansion
Legendary rarity	Partial	Low	Medium	Medium	Beta power spikes	Post-Beta Backlog	Item expansion
World-based rarity bands	Missing explicit policy	Medium	High	Medium	Needs many rewards to matter	Beta Update as design only	M130/M132

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Cursed world rarity upgrade	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Needs cursed world rules	Post-Beta Backlog	Optional-risk backlog
Keys: normal/gold/rusty	Partial lock concepts	Medium	High	Medium	Key economy scope	Prototype Later	M130/M131
Cards as single-use or run-permanent modifiers	Existing cards partial	High	High	Medium	Category confusion	Beta Update	M130
Card transforms room	Missing	Low	High	High	Big room-state mutation	Prototype Later	Post-beta card set
Card transforms enemies	Missing	Low	High	High	Encounter balance risk	Prototype Later	Post-beta card set
Card transforms whole level	Missing	Low	High	Very High	Too much scope	Cut/Defer for beta	Full-game anomaly backlog
Card returns player to hub	Missing but aligned	Medium	High	Medium	Can bypass risk if free	Prototype Later	Emergency extraction design
Card heals player	Existing-like Mend Card	High	High	Low	Must be scarce	Beta Core	M130
Card kills all monsters	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Undercuts combat	Cut/Defer for beta	Maybe late-game rare card
Card reveals map	Missing	Medium	Medium	Medium	Good utility if minimap ready	Post-Beta Backlog	Map item backlog
Beer as single-use item	Missing	Low	Medium	Low	Tone must fit	Post-Beta Backlog	Drunk NPC chain
Beer heals 3 hearts	Missing	Medium	Medium	Low	Duplicates healing unless tied to NPC	Prototype Later	Drunk NPC prototype
Beer can be given to Drunk NPC	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Needs NPC encounter	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Magic Bomb	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Needs destruction/secret rules	Post-Beta Backlog	Secret room backlog
Shield as multi-use item	Partial shield systems	Medium	High	Medium	Duplicates equipment	Prototype Later	Shield item backlog
HP regen multi-use item	Partial via mending charm	Medium	High	Low	Balance risk	Beta Update	M130
Biomass Blocker: corpses do not vanish	Missing	Low	High	Medium	Requires corpse/biomass system	Post-Beta Backlog	Biomass item backlog
HP Up always-active	Existing-like reward effects	High	High	Low	Simple and readable	Beta Update	M130
Falling Stars mini-meteors grant abilities	Missing	Medium	High	High	Needs meteor event and ability pool	Prototype Later	Post-beta anomaly rewards
Placeholder X item slots	Placeholders only	Low	Low	Low	No design content	Cut/Defer	Fill only after beta

6.6 Chests, Risk, And Rewards

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Normal chest	Existing	Critical	High	Low	Needs pacing	Beta Core	M130
Golden chest	Existing	High	High	Low	Needs reward distinction	Beta Core	M130
Mimic chest	Missing or not beta-visible	Medium	Signature	Medium	Must be readable/fair	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Cards as rewards	Existing partial	High	High	Medium	Too many effects	Beta Update	M130
HP regen/heart rewards	Existing partial	High	High	Low	Healing economy	Beta Core	M130
Shield reward	Partial	Medium	Medium	Medium	Category clarity	Prototype Later	M130 backlog
Biomass Chest	Missing	Low	High	Medium	Wait for biomass economy	Post-Beta Backlog	Biomass backlog
Souls Chest with consequences	Missing	High	Signature	Medium	Needs explicit risk consent	Beta Update	M130 if soul risk ready
Demonic Chest: item plus enemy	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Can feel punitive	Prototype Later	Optional-risk backlog
Corrupted Chest: great item plus gameplay curse	Missing	High	Signature	High	Needs curse clarity	Beta Update small subset	M130
Portal Chest to secret level	Missing	Low	High	High	Requires secret level pipeline	Post-Beta Backlog	Secret content

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Double reward after double boss	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Needs double boss balance	Post-Beta Backlog	Boss variant backlog
Second treasure room on double-boss trigger	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	System coupling	Post-Beta Backlog	Boss variant backlog

6.7 Rooms, Levels, Hubs, And Progression

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Safe start room	Existing concept	Critical	High	Low	Must stay readable	Beta Core	M131
Normal combat room	Existing	Critical	Critical	Low	Needs content quality	Beta Core	M131
Treasure room	Existing concept	High	High	Medium	Reward pacing	Beta Core	M131
Boss room	Existing	Critical	Critical	Medium	Boss polish	Beta Core	M131
Shop as room or hub object	Existing hub shop direction	High	High	Medium	Decide ship/hub role	Beta Update	M129/M131
Survival room with endless spiders for a timer	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Spawn pacing	Prototype Later	M131 candidate if cheap
Defend object room	Missing	Low	High	High	AI targeting/object health scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Room goal backlog
Wave room	Partial through encounters	Medium	High	Medium	Could drag pacing	Prototype Later	M131 candidate
Lever room	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Needs interactables	Prototype Later	Room goal backlog
Trap traversal room	Partial hazards	Medium	High	Medium	Needs readable hazards	Prototype Later	Room goal backlog
Find/destroy mimic disguised as rock	Missing	Low	High	High	Requires disguise readability	Post-Beta Backlog	Chameleon/mimic backlog
Timed kill for unique reward	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Good special encounter	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Double-boss room	Boss framework exists	Low	Medium	High	Very high balance risk	Post-Beta Backlog	Boss variant backlog
Secret cave via bombed wall	Missing	Medium	Signature	High	Needs destructible walls/map rules	Post-Beta Backlog	Secret room backlog
Bonus room via platform up/down	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Vertical transition scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Vertical backlog
Life/Death Room 50/50	Missing	Medium	Signature	High	Random punishment risk	Prototype Later	Optional-risk backlog
Levels made of rooms	Existing branch abstraction	Critical	Critical	Low	Naming consistency	Beta Core	M131
Doors lock until room goal complete	Existing core	Critical	Critical	Low	Needs visual clarity	Beta Core	M127/M131
Hub offers 3 levels/portals	Existing direction	Critical	High	Medium	Ship vs temporary hub distinction	Beta Core	M129
Hub shop	Existing direction	High	High	Medium	Currency clarity	Beta Update	M129
Return to hub after starter level and bosses	Existing/partial	Critical	High	Medium	Must feel intentional	Beta Core	M129
Emergency return via card/ability	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Can trivialize risk	Prototype Later	Extraction backlog
World contains starter level, hub, 3 levels, next-world unlock	Partial direction	High	High	High	Full structure may exceed beta	Beta Update as design target	M129/M132
Optional fourth secret level	Missing	Low	High	High	Extra content	Post-Beta Backlog	Secret world backlog
Dark worlds via special item	Missing	Medium	Signature	High	Needs alternate content	Post-Beta Backlog	Dark-world backlog
Alternate worlds via soul shop	Missing	Medium	Signature	High	Meta progression scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Alternate-world backlog

6.8 Biomes And Worlds

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Ancient Egypt / Sunken Cartouche	Existing M50-aligned	High	High	High	Asset needs	Beta candidate	M132
Prehistoric Times / Before Teeth	Existing M50-aligned	High	High	High	Enemy/prop identity	Beta candidate	M132
Fallen Future / Rust Choir	Existing M50-aligned	High	High	High	Strong with mechanical enemies	Beta candidate	M132
End of Times / Last Hour	Existing M50-aligned	Low	High	High	Too late-game for beta	Post-Beta Backlog	World backlog
The Abyss / Blind Deep	Existing M50-aligned	Medium	High	High	Needs strong visuals	Post-Beta Backlog unless chosen	M132/backlog
Interior of collapsed star/moon craters	Concept aligns with Hollow Star	Medium	Signature	High	Needs unique art language	Prototype Later	Biome prototype
Time loop world	Missing	Low	High	Very High	Systems/narrative heavy	Post-Beta Backlog	World anomaly backlog
Wreck field / spaceship graveyard	Partial via sci-fi art direction	Medium	High	High	Asset heavy	Post-Beta Backlog	Biome backlog
Hive planet that reacts	Missing	Medium	Signature	Very High	Dynamic environment/boss scope	Prototype Later	Boss/biome prototype
Zero gravity/upside-down world	Missing	Low	Signature	Very High	Movement/navigation rewrite	Cut/Defer for beta	Long-term experiment
Empty metropolis	Missing	Low	High	Very High	Large asset scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Biome backlog
Machine city / steampunk	Partially overlaps mechanical enemies	Medium	High	High	Visual identity clash with sci-fi	Post-Beta Backlog	Biome backlog
Radioactive sea	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Hazard/art scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Biome backlog
Dungeons with levers/events	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Interactables needed	Prototype Later	Room goal backlog
Tribute planets to games/films	Missing	Low	Low	Medium	IP/tone risk	Cut/Defer	Avoid direct references
Loop portal world with one true portal	Missing	Medium	Signature	High	Can frustrate players	Prototype Later	Anomaly world backlog
Heaven-Hell world	Existing Choir Below direction	Medium	High	High	Easy to overdo visually	Post-Beta Backlog unless selected	M132/backlog
Feudal Japan	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Full biome content	Post-Beta Backlog	Historical biome backlog
Medieval Europe	Partially Black Keep-aligned	Medium	High	High	Needs visual subset	Beta candidate only if chosen	M132
Roman Empire	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Extra historical biome	Post-Beta Backlog	Historical biome backlog
Ice tundra	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Terrain/hazard scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Weather biome backlog
Sandstorm desert	Missing but red land/ancient world compatible	Medium	Medium	Medium	Visibility risk	Prototype Later	Biome FX backlog
Eternal storm	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Lighting/hazard scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Weather biome backlog
Volcanic land	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Lava/hazard scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Weather biome backlog
Placeholder world slots X	Placeholder only	Low	Low	Low	No design content	Cut/Defer	Fill later

6.9 NPCs, Companions, And Special Encounters

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Companions rescued and following/helping	Missing	Medium	Signature	Very High	Full AI, UI, balance	Post-Beta Backlog	Companion system
Four-legged/minion-only play idea	Missing	Low	High	Very High	Requires companion system	Post-Beta Backlog	Challenge backlog
Escaping creature gives rare reward if killed fast	Missing	High	High	Medium	Good readable special encounter	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Dark Soul haunts after cursed chest	Partial enemy/fantasy overlap	Medium	High	High	Can feel unfair	Prototype Later	M133 or post-beta

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Drunk NPC asks for beer	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Tone must fit	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Drunk gives great reward or not	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Randomness must feel fair	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Drunk house/key secret	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Quest/secret chain scope	Post-Beta Backlog	NPC quest backlog
Alien hidden in meteor	Missing	Medium	High	High	Requires meteor/secret logic	Prototype Later	Post-beta special encounter
Meteor can be hit, bounces, needs strong weapon	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Obscure without clues	Post-Beta Backlog	Alien encounter
Soul Eater sells items for souls	Enemy exists; NPC/shop role missing	High	Signature	Medium	Soul economy clarity required	Beta candidate	M133/M129
Special NPC takes souls/money until max, becomes beast to kill, unlocks world/character	Missing	Low	Signature	Very High	Big quest/boss/unlock chain	Post-Beta Backlog	Major NPC arc
Important NPC category	Placeholder	Low	Medium	Low	Needs actual roles	Cut/Defer until named	NPC bible
Support NPC category	Placeholder	Low	Medium	Low	Needs actual roles	Cut/Defer until named	NPC bible
Encounter NPC category	Partially filled	Medium	High	Medium	Keep tiny for beta	Beta Update	M133
Special NPC category	Partially filled	Medium	High	Medium	Keep tiny for beta	Beta Update	M133

6.10 Enemies And Bosses

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Swallower cocoon eats player	Missing	Low	Signature	Very High	Instant kill/secret transport fairness	Post-Beta Backlog	Special enemy backlog
Swallower kills below 8 hearts	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Hard threshold feels arbitrary	Cut/Defer current rule	Redesign if used
Swallower transports above 8 hearts to underworld	Missing	Low	Signature	Very High	Requires secret world	Post-Beta Backlog	Underworld concept
Mimic enemy/chest	Missing/partial concept	Medium	Signature	Medium	Fair visual tell needed	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Chameleon disguises as environment	Missing	Low	High	High	Detection/readability risk	Post-Beta Backlog	Special enemy backlog
Escapist enemy	Missing	High	High	Medium	Good beta special if scoped	Prototype Later	M133 candidate
Dark Soul enemy/event	Partial through ghost/soul enemies	Medium	High	High	Can punish cursed chest too much	Prototype Later	Optional-risk backlog
Soul Eater enemy	Existing enemy archetype	Medium	High	Medium	NPC vs enemy identity	Beta Update	M133
Demonic enemy from chest	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Needs optional-risk clarity	Prototype Later	M130/M133
Spiders as room pressure	Existing small enemy foundations likely	Medium	Medium	Low	Avoid overuse	Beta Update	M131
Boss placeholder list X	Boss framework exists but PDF unnamed	Low	Low	Low	No content to implement	Cut/Defer	Use M53 boss roster
Portals with demon/wave challenges	Missing/partial challenge direction	Medium	High	Medium	Must not distract from branch loop	Prototype Later	M131/M133

6.11 Challenges, Achievements, And Unlocks

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Challenges as special runs with modified rules	Existing challenge mode	High	High	Medium	Too many variants	Beta Update	M135
Strzelec: bow only	Existing challenge style feasible	Medium	High	Low	Needs bow balance	Beta Update	M135

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
One life, no regeneration	Existing rule feasible	Medium	High	Low	Hard but clear	Beta Update	M135
Every room mini-boss, boss room has two bosses	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Balance chaos	Post-Beta Backlog	Challenge backlog
Fog of war, hidden minimap, 2x level size	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	UI/map work	Prototype Later	Challenge backlog
Speedrun, time 2x	Partial challenge feasible	Medium	Medium	Medium	Time systems	Prototype Later	Challenge backlog
Tank: 2x HP/damage, 2x slower	Feasible from stats	Medium	Medium	Low	Movement feel can suffer	Prototype Later	Challenge backlog
Four Legged Friends: minions only	Missing	Low	High	Very High	Needs companions	Post-Beta Backlog	Companion challenge
Armageddon meteor falls	Missing	Low	High	High	Needs meteor hazard	Post-Beta Backlog	Anomaly challenge
Clean Expedition: no items/upgrades/drops	Feasible	Medium	Medium	Low	Can feel empty	Prototype Later	Challenge backlog
Big world, small player	Missing	Low	Medium	High	Camera/collision/rooms	Post-Beta Backlog	Challenge backlog
Arachnophobia: all spiders	Feasible if spider roster stable	Medium	Medium	Low	Repetitive	Prototype Later	Challenge backlog
Short life: half HP, +1 after boss	Feasible	Medium	Medium	Low	Good simple rule	Prototype Later	Challenge backlog
Boss-related achievements	Missing	Medium	High	Medium	Needs achievement infra	Post-Beta Backlog	Achievement backlog
Chmielowy Sen: give beer 10 times	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Needs Drunk NPC	Post-Beta Backlog	Drunk chain
Unlock passed-out drunk	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	NPC variant scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Drunk chain
Unlock non-drinker who gives beer	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	NPC variant scope	Post-Beta Backlog	Drunk chain
Rescue 5 aliens	Missing	Low	High	High	Needs Alien encounter	Post-Beta Backlog	Alien chain
Unlock Falling Stars	Missing	Low	High	High	Needs meteor rewards	Post-Beta Backlog	Alien chain
Cleaner: kill Dark Soul with special item	Missing	Low	High	High	Needs Dark Soul/special item	Post-Beta Backlog	Dark Soul chain
Unlock dark energy projectile weapon	Missing	Low	High	Medium	Needs weapon/content	Post-Beta Backlog	Dark Soul chain
Wet Socks: hit by projectile while jumping over pod	Missing	Low	Low	High	Requires jump and odd trigger	Cut/Defer	Revisit if jump exists
You Suck: lose 20 games in row	Missing	Low	Medium	Low	Negative achievement tone	Post-Beta Backlog	Achievement backlog
Worst Behind Me: escape Death Room	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Needs Death Room	Post-Beta Backlog	Life/Death backlog
Live Happily: find three Life Rooms in one run	Missing	Low	Medium	Medium	Needs Life Rooms	Post-Beta Backlog	Life/Death backlog
Characters unlocked by puzzle pieces, one per run/random room	Missing	Low	High	High	Meta collection grind	Post-Beta Backlog	Character unlocks
Items unlocked by achievements	Partial concept	Medium	High	Medium	Needs achievement infra	Post-Beta Backlog	Unlock matrix
Alternate worlds unlocked by tasks/bosses	Missing	Medium	High	High	Scope heavy	Post-Beta Backlog	Alternate worlds

6.12 Art, Pipeline, Production, And Differentiation

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Distinguish from Isaac via 3D, story, art, melee/shooting, hubs, body consumption	Aligned with GDD	Critical	Signature	Medium	Must be visible, not just written	Beta Core	M126-M135
Distinguish from Diablo via stylized arcade/alien direction	Aligned	High	High	Medium	Visual indecision	Beta Update	M132
Less realistic, more readable stylized art	Aligned	High	High	Medium	Asset consistency	Beta Update	M132
Decide realism/fantasy/horror/blocks/pixel-art	GDD chooses stylized cosmic 3D	Critical	High	Low	Avoid reopening settled direction	Beta Core	M126

Idea	Current Status	Beta Value	Full-Game Value	Cost	Risk	Recommendation	Target
Rafal delivers 1-3 UV mapped blocks	Historical task, likely superseded by ArtPass pipeline	Medium	Medium	Low	Needs current asset standards	Beta Update	M132/art intake
Floor/edge/wall texture tests	Aligned with biome pass	High	High	Medium	Needs scale/material contract	Beta Update	M132
Asset sharing solution such as Drive	Production task	Medium	High	Low	Version-control confusion	Beta Update	M126 production notes
Document art tools	Partially documented	Medium	Medium	Low	Keep current	Beta Update	M126
Martin implements portals after bosses to hub	Existing/partial direction	Critical	High	Medium	Core loop	Beta Core	M129
Place art blocks in start board corners as debug entities	Historical debug task	Low	Low	Low	Debug-only	Cut/Defer	Superseded by Developer Lab
Spatial/model dimensions guideline	Existing docs/pipeline direction	High	High	Low	Must stay current	Beta Update	M126/M132
APIs/tools for VisionOS development	Existing platform docs partial	Medium	Medium	Medium	Unity vs RealityKit confusion	Beta Update	M126 production notes
RealityKit/Reality Composer Pro pipeline	Conflicts with current Unity project	Low	Low	High	Wrong production stack	Cut/Defer	Keep Unity as canonical
Xcode/simulator notes	Useful for platform builds only	Medium	Medium	Low	Not main implementation environment	Post-Beta Backlog	Platform QA notes
Codex/ChatGPT for planning and implementation	Existing workflow	High	Medium	Low	Must not replace review	Beta Update	M126
Higgsfield/Meshy/Hitem3D/Suno	Useful reference/asset tools	Medium	Medium	Medium	Generated asset consistency/legal/quality	Prototype Later	Art pipeline notes
Zbrush/Blender/Substance	Rafal pipeline	High	High	Low	None significant	Beta Update	M132
Existing document library inventory	Partial in repo	Medium	High	Low	Duplicates must be merged	Beta Update	M126

7. Beta Scope Decision

Beta Core

Required before beta slice lock:

- Ship-Soul loop is playable and understandable.
- Souls have visible run value and at least one permanent/ship use.
- Boss clear returns or advances the player through the loop.
- HUD shows health, current run economy, item/card state, and minimap without debug clutter.
- Normal/golden rewards and sparse room pacing are readable.
- At least one shop/choice surface exists in ship or hub.
- 2-3 beta biomes/world identities are selected and documented.
- 1-2 special encounters are selected, not a whole NPC network.
- Challenge mode remains curated and limited.

Beta Exclusions

Do not implement for beta unless a later review explicitly reopens scope:

- Full companion AI.
- Full biomass economy with corpse consumption.
- Zero gravity/upside-down worlds.
- Large character unlock puzzle system.
- Many new biomes.
- Full achievement unlock matrix.
- Secret underworld from Swallower.
- Deep alternate/dark world systems.
- Full deck/throw-card interaction model.
- Direct tribute planets based on other IP.

8. Proposed Implementation Roadmap

M126: Master Design Lock

Goal: finalize the GDD, idea catalogue, beta scope, and full-vision backlog before runtime changes.

Key outputs:

- Master design document and PDF handoff.
- Accepted beta scope list.
- Deferred full-vision backlog.
- Decision log entries for soul/biomass/ship direction.
- Production notes that Unity is canonical and RealityKit notes are legacy context only.

Acceptance:

- Every PDF idea has a sector and recommendation.

- Beta scope is small enough for a 6-9 month slice.
- No unnamed placeholder X items/worlds are treated as implementation tasks.

M127: HUD + Run Readability Pass

Goal: make normal gameplay readable without debug text.

Key outputs:

- Health hearts/avatar display.
- Run souls, coins, active item, card/consumable, and optional key slots.
- Minimap visual pass and enlarged-map design decision.
- Debug fields hidden from normal gameplay.
- Pickup/reward reveal language aligned with M42/M58.

Acceptance:

- A new player can identify health, current room, reward state, and available item/card.
- HUD works across standard and platform presentation modes.
- Developer/debug overlays remain available only through explicit debug routes.

M128: Soul + Biomass Economy Design Pass

Goal: clarify economy roles before adding more currencies.

Key outputs:

- Souls: run pickup, bank/extract, death risk, ship use.
- Coins: run/shop role.
- Biomass: design-only or tiny prototype decision.
- Black Orb and generic resources deferred.
- Soul-spending UI copy for ship repair/unlocks.

Acceptance:

- Souls do not feel like duplicate coins.
- Player understands whether continuing a run risks souls.
- Biomass is either explicitly deferred or prototyped in one contained test path.

M129: Ship-Soul Loop Greybox

Goal: make the ship the beta's structural heart.

Key outputs:

- Derelict Sanctuary greybox start/return route.
- Portal Engine or equivalent run launch device.
- Basic ship repair/unlock interaction using souls.
- Boss clear return or extraction flow.
- Memory/document clue surface.

Acceptance:

- Player can start at ship, enter run, clear a boss, return, and spend/see soul progress.
- Existing menus remain fallback, but ship communicates the fantasy.
- The ship is safe, eerie, and useful, not just a decorative menu.

M130: Reward + Chest Risk Pass

Goal: make rewards meaningful and optional risk readable.

Key outputs:

- Normal and golden chest tuning.
- Reward rarity policy for beta.
- One optional-risk chest prototype decision: corrupted, soul, mimic, or demonic.
- Healing/HP Up/card reward review.
- Deferred chest backlog documented.

Acceptance:

- Ordinary room rewards remain sparse.
- Treasure/boss/shop rewards feel more meaningful than ordinary rooms.
- Risk chest uses explicit player consent and a readable consequence.

M131: Room Type Expansion Lock

Goal: choose beta room types and stop the room-goal explosion.

Key outputs:

- Beta room whitelist: safe start, combat, treasure, boss, shop/hub, maybe one challenge room.
- Room-goal backlog for waves, survival, levers, traps, defend object, secret cave, life/death.
- Door lock/unlock readability pass.
- Branch/minimap role clarity.

Acceptance:

- Every beta room type has a clear goal and reward expectation.
- Deferred room types are recorded but not required for beta.
- Room flow supports the ship-soul loop.

M132: Biome + World Selection Lock

Goal: select 2-3 beta worlds and park the rest.

Recommended beta candidates:

- Prehistoric/Before Teeth for creature identity.
- Ancient Egypt/Sunken Cartouche for readable historical-fantasy identity.
- Fallen Future/Rust Choir for mechanical enemies and ship contrast.

Alternative candidate:

- Black Keep/medieval if art assets make it faster than one of the above.

Key outputs:

- Beta biome whitelist.
- Visual requirements for floors, walls, portals, doors, chests, props, enemy color/silhouette.
- Full-vision biome backlog.
- ArtPass asset acceptance checklist update.

Acceptance:

- Each selected beta biome has a distinct material/palette/prop plan.
- No more than 3 biomes are treated as beta scope.
- Tribute/IP-reference planets are excluded.

M133: NPC/Special Encounter Prototype Set

Goal: add one or two memorable encounters without building a full quest system.

Recommended candidates:

- Soul Eater as soul-price shop/encounter.
- Escapist as timed reward creature.
- Mimic as chest risk if chest visual tells are ready.
- Drunk NPC only if beer tone fits and implementation stays simple.

Key outputs:

- Selected special encounter list.
- Reward/risk rules.
- Art requirements.
- Deferred NPC/companion backlog.

Acceptance:

- Special encounters add identity without blocking the core loop.
- Each encounter has one clear interaction and one clear outcome.
- Companions and deep NPC quest chains remain post-beta.

M134: Combat Feel + Control Coherence

Goal: make the action set feel intentional.

Key outputs:

- Melee-first tuning.
- Ranged support tuning.
- Guard/roll/dodge readability review.
- Knockback and attack tier review.
- Controller/mouse/keyboard mapping pass.
- Consume and jump decisions confirmed as beta or deferred.

Acceptance:

- Melee is satisfying and understandable.
- Ranged is useful but not dominant by default.
- Defensive actions have clear timing and feedback.
- Control sheet matches the actual build.

M135: Beta Slice Lock + PDF Handoff

Goal: freeze beta content and hand off a testable slice.

Key outputs:

- Beta content whitelist.
- Known issues.
- Tester route.

- Updated PDF handoff.
- Whole-game audit report.
- QA checklist for ship, run, boss, reward, return, save/continue, challenge, Developer Lab, and platform scenes.

Acceptance:

- Someone outside implementation can launch, play, test, and report.
- The slice has a clear beginning, loop, boss moment, reward moment, and return-to-ship moment.
- Scope is frozen except bug fixes and obvious polish.

9. Implementation Dependencies

Dependency	Needed For	Notes
Current HUD/minimap/door readability work	M127	Finish and validate before adding new UI surfaces.
Existing save/run persistence	M128/M129	Soul extraction and ship unlocks depend on reliable state.
Existing portals/hub/branch flow	M129/M131	Reframe around ship and temporary hubs.
Existing reward/chest systems	M130	Expand carefully from normal/golden chest base.
Existing challenge mode	M135	Curate rather than expand broadly.
ArtPass wrapper and Developer Lab	M132/M133	Required for visual safety and asset intake.
Whole-game audit scaffold	M135	Convert planning scaffold into real beta evidence.

10. Full-Vision Backlog

Preserve these as future design strengths, but do not force them into beta:

- Full companion system with rescued creatures.
- Drunk NPC quest chain with beer, house key, variants, and achievements.
- Alien meteor rescue chain and Falling Stars ability rewards.
- Dark Soul curse chain and dark-energy unlock.
- Swallower underworld secret world.
- Chameleon disguise enemy.
- Portal chests and secret levels.

- Life/Death Rooms.
- Double-boss branch variants.
- Dark worlds and alternate worlds.
- Completion currency such as Black Orb.
- Character puzzle-piece unlocks.
- Full achievement unlock matrix.
- Zero-gravity/upside-down world.
- Time-loop world.
- Hive planet with reactive environment boss.
- Empty metropolis, radioactive sea, weather worlds, Roman/Japan historical worlds.
- Full 3D archive/model viewer.
- Deep ship module network beyond the beta repair/unlock loop.

11. Cut Or Deferred Without Active Design

These should not become tasks until redesigned:

- Placeholder X item/world/boss slots.
- Direct tribute planets to other games or films.
- RealityKit as the main implementation pipeline for this Unity project.
- Generic "resources" currency without a concrete use.
- Card that kills all monsters as a common/systemic effect.
- Jump-based achievement before jump is part of the core game.
- The joke identity names from the PDF.

12. Review Checklist Before Runtime Work

Use this checklist before committing implementation updates based on this document:

- Does the task strengthen the Ship-Soul Loop?

- Does it improve combat, soul meaning, rewards, ship progression, or readability?
- Is it in M126-M135, or is it explicitly post-beta?
- Can it be tested in a deterministic route?
- Does it avoid adding a broad system before the beta loop is stable?
- Does it preserve ArtPass visual-only safety?
- Does it keep debug/developer surfaces out of normal gameplay?
- Does the player understand the risk before accepting it?

13. Source Coverage

The following PDF idea groups are covered:

- Game idea notes and next-step ideas.
- Opening narrative, amnesia, portal, hidden identity, and document reveal.
- HUD, health, currencies, minimap, active items, and card deck.
- Rarity tiers and world/cursed-world rarity distribution.
- World/biome concepts.
- Consumables, cards, single-use, multi-use, always-active, special items, Falling Stars.
- Biomass, souls, Black Orb, resources, extraction choice.
- Normal/golden/mimic/biomass/soul/demonic/corrupted/portal chests.
- Rafal/Martin production tasks and asset pipeline notes.
- Isaac/Diablo differentiation notes.
- Unlock categories.
- NPCs, special encounters, companions.
- Special enemies and boss placeholders.
- Challenge and achievement ideas.
- Room types and gameplay layers.
- World/hub/level structure.
- Storytelling questions and black-hole/ship-machine concept.

- Location category lists.
- Control/action list.
- Scene I and optional story devices.

14. Final Position

The PDF contains enough material for a full roguelite, but the beta should not try to become the full roguelite. The strongest course is:

- 1 Lock this master design.
- 2 Finish readability/HUD and existing stability work.
- 3 Make souls meaningful.
- 4 Build the ship return/unlock loop.
- 5 Select a tiny content subset.
- 6 Add one memorable risk or special encounter.
- 7 Lock the beta slice and test it hard.

That path keeps the weirdness alive without letting it eat the schedule.